

S02-P — Practice: What to Recommend When Someone Asks About Latin American Art Right Now

Summary

Week two's closing practice carries into an actual conversation the criterion that ran through the previous five lessons, telling an isolated auction record apart from evidence of market depth, sales repeated across more than one house and more than one season. This note does not transcribe the simulated dialogue from the script. Instead it documents, with academic precision, the three elements an advisor needs before answering a client who asks what to look at, a method for listening and structuring the recommendation, the market evidence behind each name mentioned, and the explicit limit between institutional prestige and auction demand.

1. The method before the name

Before naming an artist, the literature on commercial practice in the art market describes a prior step, listening without imposing one's own aesthetic preference. Carola Wiese, senior art specialist in family advisory, art and collecting at UBS Global Wealth Management, described a good advisor as someone who studies, listens, and tries to stay objective in the face of the client's own taste, rather than projecting their own.¹ Once the client's goal is understood, a recommendation persuades more when it can be reconstructed with data. Dylan Lessel, co-director of Perrotin Second Marché, explained that they prepare a file with auction results, private-deal references, and comparables so the client understands how a valuation was reached, even when the gallery itself is the buyer.² That same principle, showing the reasoning rather than just the conclusion, is what structures the recommendation in this practice session. Dealer Alison Jacques added the third element, noting that collectors look for artists they can research independently in museums, and explicitly linked a Lygia Clark retrospective to renewed commercial interest.³ Verifiable institutional context, evidence of resale, and listening to the client are the three inputs that precede any given name.

2. Depth already confirmed: Amaral and Fordjour

Olga de Amaral set an artist record, USD 3,125,000, on November 19, 2025, with the textile work *Pueblo H* at Christie's.⁴ The evidence behind the recommendation, beyond that isolated number, is that between May 2025 and March 2026 at least six additional sales of her work are documented, between USD 698,500 and the record, spread across several houses.⁴ Derek Fordjour offers the same pattern among living contemporary artists, selling *Numbers* for USD 889,000 on May 14, 2024, and *Twelve Tribes* for USD 1,143,000 on November 19 of that year, twenty percent above his prior record at another house.⁵ In both cases, two separate sales, separated in time and in auction house, confirm the same price direction, the minimum evidence standard this practice requires before recommending a name with conviction.

3. The limit of institutional signal without repetition: Gego

Gego holds an institutional history equivalent to Amaral's, a traveling retrospective that passed through the Guggenheim Bilbao, the Guggenheim in New York, the Museo Jumex, and MASP in São Paulo.⁶ Her auction record, however, has remained at USD 1,512,500 since 2017, with no recent documented sales that repeat it.⁶ Firelei Báez illustrates the same limit among contemporary artists, her USD 645,000 sale on November 19, 2025, was topped that same day by another house at USD 1.11 million, with no second transaction yet to confirm whether that level holds.⁵ The most common professional error facing these two cases is extending museum prestige into a price expectation, when institutional validation and market depth are two separate phenomena that must each be verified on their own.

4. A case with both signals at once: Fernando Botero

Fernando Botero combines both kinds of evidence. His record, USD 5,132,000 with *The Musicians* in 2023, was followed by at least five more seven-figure paintings between 2024 and 2025, between USD 693,000 and USD 1,744,000, spread out over time.⁷ That market repetition is joined by an institutional signal from MoMA, which is keeping *Frida and Diego: The Last Dream*, devoted to the Mexican modernism Botero commercially descends from, open through September 12, 2026.⁸ This is the profile this practice session prioritizes for a client, repeated market activity and institutional context present at the same time, not just one of the two.

For the conversation with clients

- Before answering what to look at, the professional question is always the same for any new name, did it show one high result once, or did it repeat across more than one house and more than one year.
- A retrospective or an institutional tour certifies curatorial interest, never a promise that the auction market will follow that interest in the short term.
- Facing an offer that promises to triple a work's value in two years, the professional response asks to see the resale history first, not the seller's projection.

References

Process note: the live URL-verification fetch tool was blocked again for the entire run today, tested against theartnewspaper.com and news.artnet.com, both with an EGRESS_BLOCKED error, continuing the streak that started 2026-08-10. WebSearch worked normally. All eight citations in this note reproduce sources already verified on 2026-08-08 in the same dossiers used for the Spanish version, curso/fuentes/dossier-01-precios-latam.md, curso/fuentes/dossier-02-phillips.md, curso/fuentes/dossier-05-calendario.md, and curso/fuentes/dossier-07-tacticas-venta.md, without adding any new URL not opened today. The fresh facts used in today's four scripts (the Sotheby's and Phillips half-year results, the Lewis Collection sale, the Armory Show's new dates and its new curators and galleries) came from today's WebSearch results, each corroborated by more than one independent source, and are not cited here for that reason. The formation radar did not apply today regardless, it is not a Monday and none of PROMPT.md's three exception conditions were met. If a future run finds fetch working again, resume normal verification.

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1. Art Basel, ["Art advisor Carola Wiese on breaking her own number one rule of art fair advice"](#), 2024-06-03, verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-07-tacticas-venta.md. ↵
 2. Talking Galleries, ["Notebook 9, Barcelona Symposium 2022"](#), transcript of Dylan Lessel's remarks, dossier-07. ↵
 3. Art Basel, ["Marc Glimcher: it's not just about what's new"](#), with remarks from Alison Jacques, 2025-06-09, dossier-07. ↵
 4. Christie's, [Olga de Amaral record](#), and Phillips, [artist page](#), dossier-01. ↵↵
 5. Phillips, ["Derek Fordjour"](#) and ["Firelei Báez"](#), artist pages, dossier-02. ↵↵
 6. MutualArt, [Columna Reticulárea record](#), [Gego](#), dossier-01. ↵↵

7. Christie's, ["Latin American Art"](#), Fernando Botero record, and [March 2024 sales](#), dossier-01. ↵
8. MoMA, ["Frida and Diego: The Last Dream"](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-05-calendario.md. ↵